Critical Thinking Exercise

Giraffe in the Refrigerator

Good problem solvers stop and think before they jump in. Answer these four questions in order. Each one builds on the one before it. Write down your answer before you look at the answers.

1 How would you fit a giraffe into your refrigerator?

2 Now, how would you fit an elephant into your refrigerator?

3 The king of the animals calls a meeting of every animal. All of them come except one. Which animal is missing?

4 You need to cross a river where crocodiles live, and you have no boat. How do you get across?

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Answers

1 **How would you fit a giraffe into your refrigerator?**

Open the door, put the giraffe inside, and shut the door.

What it checks: *whether you make a simple job harder than it needs to be.*

2 **Now, how would you fit an elephant into your refrigerator?**

Open the door, take the giraffe out, put the elephant in, and shut the door.

What it checks: *whether you think about what your earlier choices changed.*

3 **The king of the animals calls a meeting of every animal. All of them come except one. Which animal is missing?**

The elephant. It is still in your refrigerator.

What it checks: *your memory.*

4 **You need to cross a river where crocodiles live, and you have no boat. How do you get across?**

Swim across. Every crocodile is at the animal meeting.

What it checks: *whether you learn quickly from a mistake.*

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